

Ciarán Coffey

ciaran@ccoffey.ie linkedin.com/in/ciaranccoffey

Profile

- Platform engineering leader with 18+ years in infrastructure, platform engineering, and operations. I lead a team with end-to-end ownership of a Kubernetes-based platform on AWS serving a global fintech SaaS product - including the data platform that feeds analytics and downstream systems (Amazon Redshift, Athena, and dbt pipelines loading from PostgreSQL). I am focused on platform reliability, automation, infrastructure as code, and delivering self-service tooling for engineering teams. Strong track record in regulated-environment governance (SOC 2, ISO 27001), vendor management, and cost optimisation. Cloud-native principles applied AWS-first today and readily transferable to Azure.

Work Experience

- RapidRatings International** (Dublin)

RapidRatings is the creator of the proprietary FHR® (Financial Health Rating), the industry's leading assessment of public and private company financial health.

SRE / Platform Engineering Manager, Mar 2023 - Present

Leading a platform engineering team with end-to-end ownership of all production and non-production infrastructure and the data platform supporting a global SaaS product.

- Built and operate the data platform: provisioned dbt pipelines loading data from PostgreSQL into Amazon Redshift, with Athena for ad-hoc and lakehouse-style querying, delivering analytics-ready data products to internal and downstream consumers
- Sole engineering owner of SOC 2 and ISO 27001 audit processes for ~3 years, liaising directly with auditors and ensuring continuous compliance in a regulated environment
- Bridge between Senior/Executive Leadership and the platform team; translating business requirements into platform and data strategy
- AWS cost management and optimisation within defined budgets, continuously identifying waste reduction and more cost-effective architectural choices
- Manage staffing and operational budgets, and vendor relationships, for the platform function
- Achieved 100% measured uptime across production services
- Architected on-demand environment provisioning via GitHub Actions, enabling ~40 developers to spin up isolated Kubernetes namespaces and deploy feature branches with a single PR comment
- Implemented Traefik ingress with Linkerd service mesh, including IP whitelisting tiers for internal, restricted, and public traffic
- Fully automated deployment pipelines using GitOps (CI/CD) workflows across dev, staging, and production environments
- Observability and monitoring via Datadog and Sentry with alerting, SLO tracking, and incident response

Lead SRE, Jan 2022 - Mar 2023

Technical lead driving the modernisation of infrastructure and operational practices.

- Led the full migration from legacy EC2/Fabric-based deployments to Kubernetes with custom Helm charts
- Designed and implemented Infrastructure as Code (Terraform) across all environments
- Migrated observability stack from Prometheus to Datadog
- Performed zero-downtime PostgreSQL major version upgrades on RDS
- Mentorship and technical guidance for other team members
- Managed cloud provider budgets and cost forecasting
- Maintained platform currency: Kubernetes, Alpine, and dependency version upgrades

Senior SRE, Nov 2016 - Dec 2021

Part of a small team managing all infrastructure and deployment needs of the company.

- AWS infrastructure provisioned and managed via Terraform
- Kubernetes platform build-out, containerising applications and migrating from persistent EC2 instances
- Instance configuration with SaltStack and Jinja templates
- CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins; application deployments with Fabric
- Infrastructure monitoring via Prometheus
- Security monitoring via Alertlogic

- Participated in 24/7 on-call rotation
- **7digital** (London)

7digital is mainly a B2B music provider of 50 million+ tracks and radio streams to a global audience
Web Operations Engineer, June 2015 - Nov 2016
 Building, testing, managing and improving 7digital's physical, virtual, and cloud infrastructure.

 - Migrated legacy hardware to AWS and Google Cloud
 - Load balancing (Nginx, HAProxy, Keepalived) and CDN management (Fastly, Varnish)
 - Automation with Chef and CFEngine; CI/CD pipelines
 - Physical, virtual (KVM, ESXi), and cloud (AWS, Google) infrastructure
 - Large-scale storage (Dell MD, GlusterFS, Google Cloud Storage)
 - Logging and observability: ELK stack, Zabbix, Grafana
- **Citrix** (Dublin)

Citrix have a broad range of products enabling people to work from any device anywhere.
*Escalation Engineer *nix*, Jun 2014 - May 2015

 - Bridge between development teams and enterprise customers for escalated issues
 - Debugging across Linux, Solaris, and AIX for the Citrix product suite
 - XenServer and VMware ESXi virtualisation; storage (FC, iSCSI, NFS, CIFS)
 - Cloud orchestration with CloudPlatform
 - Network fault finding, TLS/SSL debugging

Escalation Engineer Cloudplatform, Oct 2013 - Jun 2014

 - Dedicated Escalation Engineer for select enterprise EMEA customers
 - Managing hot issues, prioritising cases and bugs with the dev teams

Senior Xen/Unix Support Engineer, Aug 2011 - Oct 2013

 - Direct support for partners and customers; fault finding, fixing, and RCA
- **Amazon Data Services** (Dublin)

Datacentre Engineer, Mar 2011 - Aug 2011

 - Hardware fault finding and repair in a 24/7 datacentre environment
 - Physical systems installation: racks, power, networking
- **LM Ericsson** (Dublin)

Solutions Integration Engineer, Sep 2007 - Oct 2010
 Local building and onsite installation of hardware and integration into telecommunications networks.

 - Solaris (Sparc and x86), SuSe Enterprise
 - Network debugging and acceptance testing with customers
 - Provided training both on the job and in classrooms

Education

- **Kevin St. DIT** (Dublin)
BSc Hons 2:1, Computer Science (FT-228), 2003-2007

Hobbies

- Staying active: running, cycling, walking
- Keen DIYer: plumbing, electrical, tiling, carpentry